

Contract interpretation standard

COMMERCIAL STANDARD

POL-CONTRACT-002

Owner: Head of Operations with Commercial Operations | Effective: 01 August 2026 | Applies before any commitment to attend site.

Purpose

Northstar uses the service agreement to decide what the customer is entitled to, the response commitment and whether an on-site visit can be authorised. Customer language, payment advice and account-manager messages are useful context but do not replace the current agreement record.

Coverage and amendments

Coverage is determined from the active service contract together with its dated amendments.

When a later amendment conflicts with the base contract, the later amendment controls. If the customer, asset or applicable amendment cannot be established confidently, the case requires account review before dispatch.

Evidence to retain

- The customer, site and asset used for the coverage decision.
- The active contract reference and any later amendment that changed the applicable term.
- The reason for human review when the records do not support a confident decision.

Decision order

- Resolve the customer and asset before interpreting coverage.
- Find the current agreement by its effective dates and status.
- Apply the latest dated amendment when it supersedes an earlier schedule or term.
- Check the service mode. Remote-only support does not authorise an on-site dispatch.
- Use account review when the agreement is expired, suspended, missing, or conflicts with the request.

Common exceptions

A payment receipt does not reactivate a suspended account until Commercial Operations allocates it. A newly installed asset is not covered merely because the customer has a premium plan. An amendment may add equipment or change a response term from its effective date; it does not rewrite unrelated clauses.

Customer communication

When coverage is clear, state the next action and the applicable response window without quoting internal notes. When review is needed, acknowledge the operational issue, avoid promising attendance, and tell the customer that Northstar is checking the account record.

Shared by Northstar Field Services for this engagement.